

## XII. ŠALIMMA (206-210b)

According to Kt 93/k 513:17 (courtesy of C. Michel) Šalimma was a daughter of Elamma; in \*206:23 she calls Elamma's wife and his sons "her mother and brothers". She was married to Ir'am-Aššur, son of Id(d)i-bāni (see for him Ch. XI), as we know from \*206, which deals with the problems between them (see below and Veenhof 2007b).<sup>1</sup> Since Elamma's son Ennam-Aššur in \*190:34 addresses her husband as "my father, my lord", he probably was somewhat older and this might apply to Šalimma too, since according to \*208 she had two grown-up sons, Šu-lštar and Aššur-imittī, active in Kanesh, to whom she writes a letter from Assur. She may have been Elamma's oldest daughter, perhaps even a daughter from a first marriage, but there is no proof for that. She could have been the mother of Ir'am-Aššur's daughter Suhkana, married off in Kanesh to a certain Aššur-mālik according to Kt 94/k 149 (edited by Michel-Garelli 1995, 298f.), and this Suhkana then could have been one of her "children" (*šerrū*) mentioned in Ummī-lšhara's letter \*206:31-33. But Suhkana may also have been a daughter from an earlier marriage of Ir'am-Aššur.

The house in which Šalimma lived in Kanesh must have been the one of her husband Ir'am-Aššur, also after the latter had returned to Assur and she had refused to join him, as \*206 tells us. When she eventually returned to Assur her two sons may have continued to live in it, as suggested by \*208, unless they moved to the house she bought according to \*210. We would expect records that belonged to her to have turned up in her own house, from which presumably the first group excavated in 1994 (Kt 94/k 114-187; see Ch. XI, introduction) in another part of the lower town originates. The information provided by C. Michel reveals that this group of texts includes a debt-note (Kt 94/k 137) in which Šalimma is the creditor of three Anatolians (Dalaš, Kikaršan and Taliya) for an amount of 15 shekels of silver, and a contract (Kt 94/k 181, an unopened envelope) about the purchase by Šalimma of a boy from an Anatolian man (Dušala) and his two sons. The presence in Elamma's house of the letter \*206, addressed to her and her mother Lamassutum, if not one of two copies, is not surprising and this obtains also for the letter once encased in the envelope \*207. The presence in Elamma's house of \*209 and \*210, in which Šalimma is creditor and buyer, and of the letter written to her sons, \*208, may be due to what happened after her return to Assur, but we have no information on it. The family ties between Elamma and Ir'am-Aššur may also be responsible for the presence of a few records of members of one family in the archive of the other, such as some documents of Lamassutum in Ir'am-Aššur's archive (a debt-note of her, Kt 94/k 120, and a contract with Iddin-Aššur about the conditional sale of a girl, dated to eponymy year 100).<sup>2</sup>

### 206. Kt 91/k 385 (1-239-91)

---

<sup>1</sup> In a letter written by Ir'am-Aššur to Husārum (Kt 94/k 438: 25-30, courtesy of G. Barjamovic), Šalimma is designated by Ir'am-Aššur as *kallutum*, "bride". We read: "For your sake the 25½ shekels of silver, the pectoral of your<sup>plur.</sup> bride Šalimma, I gave back to her. For three years it was out of my control, but when I was about to leave on my journey she gave it back" (*aššumika 1/3 mana 5 1/2 GÍN / KÙ.B. tudittam ša Ša-li-ma / kallitikunu ú-ta-er-ši-ma / MU.3.ŠÈ : i-bi<sub>4</sub>-lá-ni-ma / ina bāb harrānia / tù-ta-e-ra-šu*). Is "your bride" a girl married off by Husārum c.s. or one that had just entered his family as bride?

<sup>2</sup> The contacts between the families suggests that this Lamassutum is indeed Elamma's wife.

A long, emotional letter sent from Assur by Elamma's daughter Ummī-lšhara to her mother Lamassutum and in particular to her sister Šalimma in Kanesh, on the problems the latter is causing by her refusal to join her husband Ir'am-Aššur in Assur, of which Ummī-lšhara, due to her efforts to mediate between the two, is becoming the victim. I have edited this remarkable letter, with a long commentary, in Veenhof 2007b, to which I refer the reader for detailed comments. The assumption that she did return in the end to Assur is perhaps confirmed by her mention in Kt c/k 30+:16-17 (courtesy Dercksen), a list of amounts of silver sent to Assur: "10 shekels (of silver) a gift/consignment (*šēbultum*) for Šalimma and Masātum".

- 1     *a-na Lá-ma-sà-tim ú Ša-lim-ma qí-bi-ma*  
       *um-ma Um-mi-lš-ha-<ra>-ma a-dí-i na-áš-pé-er-tim*  
       *ša ta-áš-pu-ri-ni um-ma a-tí-ma mi-šu-um*  
       *ma-ma-an lá i-ṭa-ra-dam ší-pá-ar-šu*
- 5     *i-li-kam-ma : a-na-ku aṭ-ru-ud : a-dí ma-lá*  
       *ú ší-ni-šu aq-bi-šu-ma li-bu-šu : i-ta-na-aṣ-/ra-áp*  
       *um-ma šu-ut-ma : a-dí : ma-lá : ú ší-ni-šu*  
       *na-áš-pé-er-tí : i-li-ik-ší-im-ma a-lá-kam*  
       *lá ta-mu-a : ša a-ša-pá-ru-ší-ni-BA i-ṣé-er*
- 10    *na-áš-pé-ra-tí-a iṣ-té-et : ú ší-ta : ša i-li-kà-/ší-ni*  
       *a-wi-lúm : a-wa-tim : i-ta-ah-dar*  
       *[u]m-ma šu-ut-ma iṣ-tù a-lá-kam lá ta-mu-ú*  
       *lá ta-tù-ri-ma : lá ta-qá-bi-im*  
       *šu-ma : a-ha-tí a-tí : a-wa-tim sà-ra-tim*
- 15    *lá ta-áš-ta-na-pá-ri-im : a-na KÙ.B. mi-ma*  
       *lá ta-ša-pá-ri-šu-um : a-šu-mi KÙ.B. aq-bi-šu-ma*  
       *um-ma šu-ut-ma : ma-lá-ma-a : KÙ.B. 1/2 ma-na*  
       *gám-ri-ša : gis-mi-lamṣ : i-ṣé-er um-mi-ša*
- 19    *ú-ul a-he-ša lá-áš-ku-un ú-ul*
- l.e.   *i-na ba-áb-tí-a KÙ.B. 10 GÍN lá i-ba-ší*  
       *ú šu-ma : i-na ba-áb-tí-a lá-šu*
- rev.   KÙ.B. 10 GÍN : *ma-lá : gám-ri-ša*  
       *iṣ-tí um-mi-ša : ú <<ta>> a-hi-ša*  
       *lu té-ri-iṣ-ma : a-na-ku a-na-kam : lu-ta-er-šu-ma*
- 25    *lu ta-ta-al-kam : mi-ma : a-wa-tim*  
       *ú na-áš-pé-ra-tim : lá ta-áš-ta-na-pá-ri-im*  
       *i-na pá-ni : a-wi-lim : tù-uš-ta-zi-zi*  
       *um-ma šu-ut-ma iṣ-tù-ma lá am-tí-ni : ší-it*  
       *a-lá-kam lá ta-am-tù-a-ni : lá ta-tù-ar-ma*
- 30    *šu-um-ša : lá ta-za-kà-ri-im : ú a-tí*  
       *lá a-ha-tí mi-šu-um šé-re-ki ú É bé-et-ki*  
       *ša-ni-ú-tum : i-bé-e-lu : ú a-tí : a-ma-kam*  
       *wa-áš-ba-tí : a-pu-tum : šé-re-ki : lá tù-ha-li-qí*  
       *ú i-a-tí i-na É a-wi-lim : lá tù-re-qí-ni*
- 35    *šu-ma : a-lá-ki : i-ba-ší : tí-ib-e-ma a-tal-ki-im*  
       *lá-ma a-wi-lúm li-bu-šu : iṣ-ni-ú*  
       *i-na dUTU-ši : Pí-lá-ah-lštar : e-ru-ba-ni*  
       *ki-ma iṣ-tí-šu lá ta-li-ki-ni : li-bu-šu*

- im-ra-aš-ma : 5 u<sub>4</sub>-me-e : a-na ki-dim*  
 40 *lá ú-ší : šu-ma : mu-tám : ša-ni-a-am*  
*ta-šé-e-i : šu-up-ri-ma : lu i-dé*  
*šu-ma lá ki-a-am : tí-ib-<e>-ma a-tal-ki-/im*  
 u.e. *šu-ma : lá ta-li-ki-im*  
*i-a-tí : i-na pá-ni : a-wi-lim*  
 45 *tù-ša-zi-zi*  
 le.e. *ú šé-re-ki : tù-ha-li-qí : ú a-na-ku*  
*lá a-tù-ar-ma : šu-um-ki lá a-za-kà-ar*  
*ú-lá a-ha-tí a-tí ú mi-ma i-a-tí*  
*lá ta-ša-pí-ri-im*

To Lamassutum and Šalimma, thus says Ummī-lšhara:

"As for the letter 3 you sent me, in which you wrote: "Why does he not send someone to me?", a messenger of his 5 did arrive, but it was me who sent him away. I talked to him several times, but every time he bursts out, 7 saying: "Several letters of mine went to her, but she refused to come here! Could what I would write her (now) really surpass 10 the messages that already reached her several times?".

11 The gentleman has become very annoyed by the matter and said: "Because she refuses to come, 13 you must not again speak to me!" 14 If you are my sister, do not keep writing me things that are not true and certainly do not write him for silver. I talked to him because of the silver 17 and he said: "Should I really oblige her mother or her brothers for no less than half a mina of silver for her expenses? 19 Are there no ten shekels of silver available from my outstanding claims? 21 And if they are not, let her ask ten shekels of silver for her expenses 23 from her mother or her brothers, which I promise to pay back here, if only 25 she leaves for here". 26 Do not keep writing me all kind of things and messages. 27 You have brought me into conflict with the gentleman. 28 He tells me: "Since, not being my maid, she refuses to come here, 30 you must not mention her name to me again, lest you will no longer be my sister!" Why are others ruling your children and your household, while you are staying there? 33 Please, do not make your children perish and do not estrange me from the gentleman's house. 35 If you see a possibility to come, get ready and leave for here, 36 before the gentleman gets different ideas. 37 The day Pīlah-lštar arrived here, since you had not accompanied him, 39 he felt very unhappy and for five days did not leave his house. If you are seeking another husband, write me so, I wish to know it. 42 If not, get ready and leave to come here.

43 If you do not come, you will bring me into conflict with the gentleman 46 and you will make your children perish and I, 47 I will never again mention your name, you will no longer be my sister and 49 you don't have to write me any more."

#### Notes

See the edition in Veenhof 2007b.

**15.** Kouwenberg calls my attention to the occurrence of several verbal forms without vowel assimilation: *taštanapparim* (15, 26), *tašappariššum* (16), *tazakkarim* (30), alongside forms with assimilation, e.g. *tašappirim* (l. 49).

**27.** *tušazzizī*, with a fem. subject and apparently a 1<sup>st</sup> pers. sing acc. suff., alongside *jāti* .... *tušazzizī* (lines 44-45).

**29-30.** Kouwenberg suggests that in *ta-tù-ar-ma* ... *tazakkarim*, with a masc. and a fem. form, the first is a mistake for *ta-tù-ri-ma*.

## 207. Kt 91/k 386 (1-240-91)

The reverse of an envelope (6.8 x 5.4 cm) of a letter whose bottom is damaged, with impressions of the seals of its two writers, one of which is that of Ir'am-Aššur. The name of the first addressee is missing, but must be Lamassutum according to the impression of some lines of the letter inside on the inside of the envelope; the second is Šalimma.

|      |                                                          |                                                      |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | [KIŠIB .....]<br>[KIŠIB .....]<br>[a-na .....]<br>seal A | [Seal of .....and ]<br>[seal of .....]<br>[to .....] |
| rev. | seal B<br>ù Ša-lim-ma<br>a-ša-at                         | and Šalimma,<br>the wife of                          |
| 5    | Ir-ma-A-šur<br>seal B                                    | Irma-Aššur                                           |

*Seals*

seal A = CS 1147

seal B = CS 1148 = 223C and \*226A, with the inscription: *l'- x hu-šu' / lp-hu-ur-D[a-mu'] / ša me-ku-um / i-ra-mu-š[u]*, a seal originating from Ebla and owned by Ir'am/Narām-Aššur, son of Id(d)i-bāni, who figures as witness; see Teissier 1994 no. 527.

Traces of the text readable on the inner side of the envelope:

|   |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                              |                                               |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1 | x x [ ..... ]<br>°a-na <sub>2</sub> La-ma-sà-tim<br>ú Ša-lim-ma um-ma Ú-[<br>a-na Ša-lim-ma qí-bi <sub>4</sub> -ma | um-ma A-.....<br>x ta .....<br>10 ša-im <sup>2</sup> ..... a-na šu-x-<br>x x ITU iš-té-en a-ta x x<br>5 x x x ta-ak-ta-.....<br>a-li lá .....<br>ni-zí-..... | 14 x x x x-šu Ir-ma-A-[šur <sup>2</sup> ..... |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|

*Comment*

What is readable shows that this is not part of the envelope of the letter 206\*, as I assumed in Veenhof 2007b. This is confirmed by the presence of two different seal impressions, observed by Mrs Omura, of which one belongs to Ir'am-Aššur. It therefore must have been written by him, together with somebody else and we might expect her to be Ummī-lšhara. But this cannot be checked, because we do not know her seal, and is unlikely because her name is always spelled with initial *Um-*, not with *Ú-*. There are clear traces on the inside of the envelope of line 1, which one would expect to start with *um-ma* followed by the names of the writers. There is, however, hardly room for two names, and, moreover, at the end of l. 3 we do not have the usual *qibima*, but an unexpected *um-ma*. Then follows a repeated "say to Šalimma", which identifies her as the main addressee. Nothing can be made of the contents of the letter, but l. 14 may mention Ir'am-Aššur, Šalimma's husband, who must have sent this letter to her from Assur. The presence of this envelope in the archive suggests that the document was

broken due to the damage suffered by the house, but I have been unable to find the letter it must have contained.

### 208. Kt 91/k 499 (1-352-91)

A letter by Šalimma addressed to her sons Šu-lštar and Aššur-imittī, in particular to the latter, in which she asks them to retrieve a debt-note from her tablet coffer and to let Šu-lštar bring it to her so that she can counter an attack by her debtor. “Here” (l. 14) probably refers to Assur, in which case she wrote this letter when she had returned to Assur.

|       |                                                |                             |
|-------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|       | <i>um-ma Ša-lim-ma-/ma</i>                     | Thus Šalimma,               |
|       | <i>a-na Šu-lštar</i>                           | say to Šu-lštar,            |
|       | <i>ù a-na A-šūr-i-mi-tí &lt; qí-bi-ma &gt;</i> | and Aššur-imittī,           |
|       | <i>a-na A-šūr-i-mi-tí</i>                      | especially to Aššur-imittī: |
| 5     | <i>qí-bi-ma me-er-i</i>                        | “Please, my son,            |
|       | <i>a-ta : ta-ma-lá-ki</i>                      | open my tablet              |
|       | <i>ša ṭup-pé-a</i>                             | coffer                      |
|       | <i>pí-tí-a-ma</i>                              | and take out of it          |
| l.e.  | <i>ṭup-pá-am</i>                               | the tablet of               |
| rev.  | <i>ša hu-bu-ul</i>                             | the debt of                 |
| 11    | <i>lī<sub>5</sub>-ba-ni šé-li-a-ma</i>         | lī <sub>5</sub> -bāni       |
|       | <i>Šu-lštar</i>                                | and let Šu-lštar            |
|       | <i>lu-ub-lá-šu</i>                             | bring it here.              |
|       | <i>a-na-kam : ša-al-tám</i>                    | Here he has started         |
| 15    | <i>iš-tí-a e-pu-/uš-ma</i>                     | a fight with me             |
|       | <i>lī-bi<sub>4</sub>-i</i>                     | and has offended me         |
|       | <i>da-ni-iš uš-ta-am-ri-iš</i>                 | seriously.                  |
| le.e. | <i>me-er-ú-a</i>                               | Please, my sons,            |
| 20    | <i>a-tù-nu ih-da</i>                           | pay attention!”             |

#### Notes

6. I prefer to take *tamalakkī* as “my tablet coffer” rather than as plural. That the request is addressed to her sons implies that they lived in her house in Kanesh and were authorized to retrieve the tablet in question. Note that while Šalimma addresses Aššur-imittī in particular (*attā*, “you”, l. 6), the ensuing imperatives are all in the plural.

11. Which of the at least three different lī<sub>5</sub>-bāni’s that occur in the archive (the most frequent is a son of lī<sub>5</sub>-ilī) is meant is unknown.

### 209. Kt 91/k 518A/B (1-371-91)

A complete tablet with a piece of the sealed reverse of its envelope recording a silver debt due to Šalimma by what probably is an Anatolian couple (their names are not attested in other texts). The preservation of tablet and envelope suggests that it was not opened and therefore not paid in antiquity. It contains stipulations on the equivalent in grain of the silver debt, on its interest and on its payment. I have published and discussed this record in Veenhof 2015, as text 7.

## A. Case

|      |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                               |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|      | seal A                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                               |
| 1'   | <i>i-na ha-a[r-pì-im .....]</i><br><i>i-ša A-na °KÙ.B. i-[-[ša-qú-lu]</i><br><i>KÙ.B. i-na *áb-nim ni-°a-tim]</i><br><i>ta-ki-tám i-ša-qú-lu</i><br>(1 cm. blank) | in sum[mer they will.....]<br>At Anna's festival they will pay the silver.<br>They will weigh it out by our weight,<br>in the correct amount. |
|      | seal A                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                               |
| u.e. | seal B                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                               |

## B. Tablet

|      |                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|      | 15 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>i-še-er</i><br><i>lš-ha-ša-ra ú A-li-a-ah-/šu-šar</i><br><i>Ša-lim-ma tí-šu</i><br><i>6? na-ru-uq ú-tá-tí-im / i-na</i>                                 | 15 shekels of silver<br>lšhašara and Aliahšušar<br>owe to Šalimma.<br>6? sacks of grain,                                                                                                            |
| 5    | ŠÀ.BA <i>na-ru-uq ú 2 kà-ar-pá-at</i><br><i>ar-ša-tim ší-ib-tám</i><br><i>ú-šú-bu i-na ha-ar-pì-im</i><br><i>i-ša-qú-lu ú 10 ak-le</i><br><i>ú-šú-bu IGI I-na-Sú-in</i> | - thereof 1 sack and 2 jars<br>of wheat they will add<br>as interest – they will pay in the<br>summer and they will add<br>10 breads. Before Ennam-Suen,<br>before Tarakša, and<br>before Tarikuta. |
| 10   | IGI <i>Ta-ra-ak-ša</i><br>IGI <i>Ta-ri-ku-ta</i>                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| l.e. | <i>šu-ma KÙ.B. ú-ta-ru*-nim</i>                                                                                                                                         | When they give back silver                                                                                                                                                                          |
| rev. | <i>i-ša A-na i-ša-qú-lu</i>                                                                                                                                             | they will pay at Anna's festival.                                                                                                                                                                   |

## Seals

Seal A = CS 1229. Seal B = St ....., damaged, still visible the upper part of two circles. Who owned which seals is not clear. There may originally have been three (if the Anatolian couple used one seal) or four seal impressions.

## Notes

**A:1'.** At the end of the line we need a verb with grain as object, either *šaqaalum* (surprisingly used in B:8), *madādum*, *tadānum* or *wabālum*.

**A:3'- 4'.** A clause stipulating which weight is to be used when paying back (not written in B), occurs more frequently in debt-notes, see AOATT 57f. and *Copper*, 80-89. See for more examples of the adverbial accusative *takittam*, "correctly, in the correct amount", the comments on these lines (text 7:A:3'-4') in Veenhof 2015 and Veenhof, *Lex.*, s.v. Comparable clauses in native grain loans prescribe which measuring jar (*karputum*) is to be used, cf. K. Balkan, in *Studies Güterbock*, 39f.

**B:3.** *i-na* written between lines 3 and 4 is difficult. Pleonastic *ina* ŠÀ.BA for ŠÀ.BA alone (= *ina qerbišu*) occurs more often in OA.

**7-10.** Different due dates for payment in grain and silver are well attested, see Veenhof 2008a, 241f., where our text can be added to those listed under a), comparable to no. 4. Payment in grain is always earlier (in the summer, at harvest time) than that in silver, since the festival of Anna was in (late) autumn.

## Comment

The Anatolian couple probably had become indebted by a loan or by the obligation to deliver goods already paid for and the debt rated in silver is to be paid back in grain. The fact that payment in silver (called "to give back", *ta"urum*) is only an alternative

shows that the goal of Šalimma's transaction was to obtain grain, presumably not for commercial purposes, but for her own stocks. Another contract that offers such a choice is Kt d/k 20B:13-16, concerning a silver debt of 45 shekels, "If they give (back) barley, it will be deducted from their account according to the current rate of exchange". This implies that the 6 sacks of line 4 are the equivalent of the 15 shekels of silver, which yields an acceptable price of 2½ shekels of silver for one sack of grain.<sup>3</sup> I thus assume that lines 4-7 do not state the amount of interest to be paid, "6 sacks of grain (*uṭṭutum*), 1½ of which are wheat", but that the main sentence consists of l. 4+8a: "6 sacks of grain ..... they will pay at harvest time", into which the stipulation about interest is embedded, where the use of the verb *šaqaḷum* in l. 8 reflects that what the debtor had received was silver. The use of *ina* ŠÀ.BA, "thereof", to denote the interest *on* a debt is strange and unique.<sup>4</sup> ŠÀ.BA is used to specify the composition of an amount of goods, e.g. that an amount of grain to be delivered must consist of two different kinds, barley and wheat - hulled barley and bread wheat, best attested among plant remains from Central Anatolia from this period<sup>5</sup> - and it seems possible that the writer of our contract was influenced by it. The amount of interest, 1½ sacks of wheat, considering that wheat is often 50% more expensive than barley,<sup>6</sup> would equal an interest of at least 2½ sacks of barley or ca. 40 to 50%, which is an acceptable rate. It is a pity that little remains of the text on the envelope, which might have given a clue. The obligation, mentioned after the payment clause, that they will give 10 breads as "additional gift", is a well-known feature, studied by Matouš 1965, 180f., "Exkurs über Zugaben".

The due date for the expected payment in grain is *harpū*, the summer, the time of the harvest; that for payment in silver some months later, at the festival of Anna, in autumn, probably to leave the debtors some time to acquire silver by selling part of

<sup>3</sup> A different case is the contract Kt f/k 65B (courtesy L. Umut), which states that the creditor has a claim on an Anatolian couple of 15 shekels of silver, which they received at the time of the festival of Tuhtuhānum, in month VII. Then follows (lines 7ff.) "5 sacks of barley (and) 1 sheep they will give as interest at the time when the sickles are seized" (= at harvest time), followed by "they will give the silver back at the time of the festival of Tuhtuhānu". Here the 5 sacks of barley are a very high interest, to be paid *in natura* in summer, several months before the due date for the silver in autumn.

<sup>4</sup> The contract does not use *madādum*, "to measure out", or the more general *tadānum*, "to give" (used in mixed loans), and in B:12 does not use *šaqaḷum*, but "to give back" (*ta'urum*, B:12) the silver.

<sup>5</sup> See Dercksen 2008b, 145. See for references to grain specified as "x barley and y wheat", CAD Š/II, 308f., s.v. *aršātu*, and for examples of "half barley, half *aršātu*", ATHE 75:6-7, KKS 8:2-3, and 31:2-3. Also grain to be paid as interest, as in our contract, can be said to be of two kinds, e.g. in ATHE 6:7-9, where three Anatolians owe Pūšu-kēn 69 shekels of refined *litu*-silver and have to pay him in the summer as interest "[x] sacks [of grain, half] barley, half [*aršātu*]" (corrected reading).

<sup>6</sup> There are great differences in the prices of grain, see also Michel 1997a 101, with notes 49-51. They were conditioned by the time of the year, the situation (CCT 5, 37a:5, *ina dannitim*, "during distress, famine"), and the purpose (private consumption or trade, purchase or sale). In TC 2, 53:1-16 wheat plus barley were purchased for on average 7 shekels of silver per sack and sold at double that price, followed by cases where persons "took" barley or wheat for much lower prices. In ATHE 12:22-25 the price of wheat was even 18 shekels per sack (4½ shekels per jar). In ICK 2, 2:2'-4' wheat was ca. two and a half times more expensive than barley ("30 sacks of barley instead of 12 sacks of wheat"), but in Kt 88/k 71:15-17 (see AoF 35 [2008] 97) the difference was only ca. 50% (barley at ca. 1 1/6 shekel per sack, wheat ca. 1 2/3 shekel) and in \*343 barley cost 3 shekels per sack, wheat 5 shekels.

their harvest. This seems to be a more general pattern and for examples I refer to *OBO* 160/5, 242f., where the due date for grain is also designated as “at harvest time” (*ina ebūrim*) and “on the threshing-floor” (*ina/ina erāb adrim*), and that for silver also as “when the grapes are plucked” (*ina qitip kerānim*),<sup>7</sup> which means in early autumn.

## 210. Kt 91/k 522 (1-375-91)

The deed by which a house owned by Ištar-lamassī and Aššur-ṭāb was sold to Šalimma for the substantial price of 2½ minas of silver. The sellers will protect the new owner against claims and have given her the deed of sale by which they had previously acquired it from an Anatolian. Previously edited and studied in Veenhof 2003b, 693ff., no. 1.

|      |                                            |                                  |
|------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
|      | °É <sub>2</sub> ša Ištar-lá-ma-/sí         | The house of Ištar-lamassī       |
|      | ù A-šùr-DÙG                                | and Aššur-ṭāb, they              |
|      | a-na 2½ ma-na                              | sold to Šalimma                  |
|      | KÙ.B. a-na                                 | for 2½ minas                     |
| 5    | Ša-lim-ma i-dí-nu-ma                       | of silver,                       |
|      | KÙ.B. ší-im É-šu-nu                        | and with price for their house   |
|      | A-šùr-DÙG ù Ištar-lá-ma-sí                 | Aššur-ṭāb and                    |
|      | ša-bu-ú                                    | Ištar-lamassī are satisfied.     |
| 9    | É <sup>bé-tù</sup>                         | That house (now)                 |
| l.e. | ša Ša-lim-ma                               | belongs to Šalimma.              |
| rev. | šu-ma ma-ma-an                             | If anybody raises a claim        |
|      | a-na É <sup>be-tí</sup> i-tù-a-ar-/<ší>-im | against her for the house,       |
|      | A-šùr-DÙG ù Ištar-lá-ma-/sí                | Aššur-ṭāb and Ištar-lamassī      |
|      | ù-bu-bu-ší                                 | will clear her.                  |
| 15   | ṭup-pá-am ša ší-im                         | The tablet recording the payment |
|      | É <sup>be-tí</sup> a-ni-ú-tim              | for this house with the seal     |
|      | ša ku-nu-uk nu-a-im                        | of the Anatolian who was         |
|      | be-el É pá-nim A-šùr-DÙG                   | the previous owner of the house, |
|      | a-na Ša-lim-ma i-dí-in                     | Aššur-ṭāb has given to Šalimma.  |
| 20   | IGI °UTU-ba-ni                             | In the presence of Šamaš-bāni,   |
|      | [IGI] A-šur-ma-lik                         | [of] Aššur-mālik,                |
|      | [IGI] Sú-in-SIPAD                          | [of] Suen-rēī.                   |

### Notes

1. In Veenhof 2003b, 694 with note 4, I compared the formulation of KKS 21, where *bētu ša A.*, “the house of A.”, is the fore-grounded object of the action of the sellers, who are not the owners (*ana PN ana šīmim iddinūma*). We can assume the same construction in our text, where the owners are the sellers, if we accept that the subject of *iddinūma* is not repeated.

9-10. Kienast 1984, § 69, calls this the “Geschäftsabschlussvermerk”, a rather vague term for a clause that serves to establish the new ownership of the buyer.

<sup>7</sup> A new example in Kt 93/k 148:8-16, with a debt of [x] shekels of silver: “They will give 5 jars of *aršātum* and 5 jars of barley at harvest time (*ebūrum*); the silver they will pay when the grapes are picked” (*iqqatāp kerānim*). In Kt o/k 72, on a mixed debt, grain must be given *ina ebūrim*, silver *ina harpē*, which suggests that the latter is somewhat later.



15. This is the first time that the deed of sale of a house mentions the transfer to the buyer of the earlier title-deed that documents its acquisition by the seller. All previous references to and information on this custom, almost exclusively from Old Babylonian times, are found in letters and records of litigation, never in deeds of sale; see Veenhof 2003b, 694f.

*Comment*

It is tempting, although both names are not rare, to identify Ištar-lamassī with Elamma's daughter of that name and Aššur-ṭāb with her brother. If so, the fact that Ištar-lamassī is mentioned as first seller in l. 1, but figures after Aššur-ṭāb in lines 7 and 13, might reflect the fact the house sold was the one bought by Ištar-lamassī's first Assyrian husband, Kūn-ilum, which she had inherited and now sold after his early death, assisted by her younger brother.

**210bis. Kt 86/k 155A/B (2-38-86)**

I add here the colonial verdict Kt 86/k 155, in which Šalimma also figures prominently.

**A. Case**

seal A

KIŠIB *kà-ri-im Kà-ni-iš*  
*kà-ru-um dī-nam*  
*i-dī-in-ma*  
*i-t[a-m]a A-mur-Ištar*

seal B

5 *i-n[a GÍR] ša A-šūr*

seal C

l.e. *b[é]tù i-na KÙ.B.-áp*

rev. *Ša-lim-ma lu ša-mu-ni*

seal D

*li-bu-šu la i-dé-ú*  
*ki-ma KÙ.B. La-ma-sí-tí-ni*

10 *šu-ma A-mur-Ištar i-ta-ma*  
*bé-tù ša Ša-lim-ma*  
*šu-ma la i-ta-ma*  
*ta-ta-ma La-ma-sú-tum*  
*i-na hu-pí-im ša Ištar*

15 *bé-tù i-na KÙ.B.-áp*  
*l-dí-Sú-in la<sub>1</sub> ša-mu-ni*  
*i-na KÙ.B.-pì-ša lu ša-mu-ni*  
*šu-ma °ta-ta-ma bé-tum<sub>2</sub>*

seal E

u.e. *bé-sà*

seal F (upside down)

20 *šuma A-mur-Iš-tar ù La<sub>1</sub>-ma-sú-tum*  
*la<sub>1</sub> i-ta-am-ú-ma*  
*i-ta-am-gu<sub>5</sub>-ru 4 ma-na K[Ù.B.]*

seal F

*i-ší-im bé-tí kà-ru-um*

seal G

ri.e. *i-lá-qé*

**B. Tablet**

*kà-ru-um dī-nam*  
*i-dī-in-ma*  
*i-ta-ma A-mur-Ištar*

*i-na GÍR ša A-šūr*

5 *bé-tù i-na KÙ.B.-áp*  
*Ša-lim-ma <lu> ša-mu-ni*  
*li-bu-šu la i-dé-ú*  
*ki-ma KÙ.B.-áp*  
*Lá-ma-sí-tí-ni*

10 *šu-ma A-mur-Ištar i-ta-ma*  
*bé-tu ša Ša-lim-ma*  
*šu-ma la i-ta-ma*  
*ta-ta-ma La-ma-sú-tum*

l.e. *i-na hu-pì-im ša Ištar*

15 *bé-tù i-na KÙ.B.-áp*  
*l-dí-Sú-in*  
*[l]a<sub>1</sub> ša-mu-ni*  
*°i<sub>2</sub>-na KÙ.B.-pì-ša*  
*°lu<sub>2</sub> ša-mu-ni*

20 *[š]u-ma ta-ta-ma*  
*bé-tum bé-sà*  
*šu-ma A-mur-Ištar*  
*ù La<sub>1</sub>-ma-sú-tum*  
*la<sub>1</sub> i-ta-am-ú-ma*

25 *i-ta-am-gu<sub>5</sub>-ru*  
*4 ma-na KÙ.B. i-ší-im*  
*bé-tí kà-ru-um / i-lá-qé*

*Seals*

seal A: inscription: *A-šūr*-[.....] / DUMU *A*-[.....]

seal D: inscription: *A-mur-lštar* / DUMU *Puzur<sub>4</sub>-lštar*

seal F: inscription *A-šūr*-DINGIR / DUMU x [.....]

The other seals have no inscriptions

*Translation*

"Seal of the Kanesh colony. The colony passed the following judgment: Amur-lštar will swear by Aššur's dagger (6) that he house has truly been bought with Šalimma's silver, that he (tablet adds: his heart) honestly did not know that the silver belonged to Lamassutum. (10) If Amur-lštar swears the house belongs to Šalimma. If he does not swear Lamassutum will swear by the tambourine(?) of lštar (15) that the house was not bought with Iddin-Suen's silver, but was bought with her own silver. If she swears the house is her house. Should Amur-lštar and Lamassutum (20) (both) not swear but reach a compromise, the colony will take 4 minas of silver from the price of the house.

*Notes*

The scribe consistently used the sign LA<sub>1</sub> and wrote Lamassutum's name with vowel harmony.

**6-8.** As *libbušu* shows, the oath, in the subjunctive, is not quoted as direct speech, but as a dependent clause, without introducing conjunction.

**15.** We already knew that a woman does not swear by Aššur's dagger, but by the hoop (*huppum*) of lštar, from Kt 94/k 131: 8-13 (see Michel 1997c, 111-112), "If it is a male by Aššur's dagger, if it is a female by lštar's tambourine(?) one will swear".

**19.** The use of the singular here shows that the plural *bētū* in lines 5, 11 and 15 also refers to a single house.

*Comment*

This verdict may well concern the house bought by Šalimma from her sister and brother according to \*208. The names of the persons mentioned in the verdict may support this view, for Amur-lštar could be Elamma's brother of that name and Iddin-Suen the father of Elamma and Amur-lštar. The ownership of the house depends on the question whether it was paid with the buyer's private money or with money «of the family» (inherited from Iddin-Suen). That Šalimma herself is not present and does not swear suggests that she had died (in Assur, where she had returned?) and that the ownership of the house had to be established before it could be inherited (by Amur-lštar?). Amur-lštar first gets the opportunity to swear to defend his case and it is remarkable that he not only has to confirm the purchase with Šalimma's money (as he no doubt had claimed), but also his honesty by denying any knowledge of what the other party has claimed. If he fails (refuses) to do so the other party is not automatically granted the ownership, because there are still two possibilities: purchase with the money inherited from the *pater familias* (which must have consequences for the inheritance) or with Lamassutum's private money. Unfortunately we do not know what was the result of the oath procedure.

If both parties at the last moment - after the colony had convened and the verdict had been issued and before the oath ceremony- reach a compromise, the colony will be indemnified for the trouble they had caused it by a heavy fine to be paid by the parties. This heavy fine probably served as a deterrent, which is understandable in view of the great number of legal cases to be tried by the colonial authorities. Parties are warned to consider carefully whether they are going to make an appeal. In our case

they might consider whether the price of an Assyrian house in the colony was high enough to run that risk.